



Mating and hibernating

Adults mate in September. During winter, when there are fewer insects around, the bats go into hibernation. Their body temperature drops, and they stop flying altogether. They lose weight but are able to survive on their body fat.

Bat

Bats are the only mammals that can fly like a bird. However, instead of feathers, they have wings made of thin webbed skin. Some bats eat fruit, but most munch on insects—this includes the big brown bat, found throughout North America.



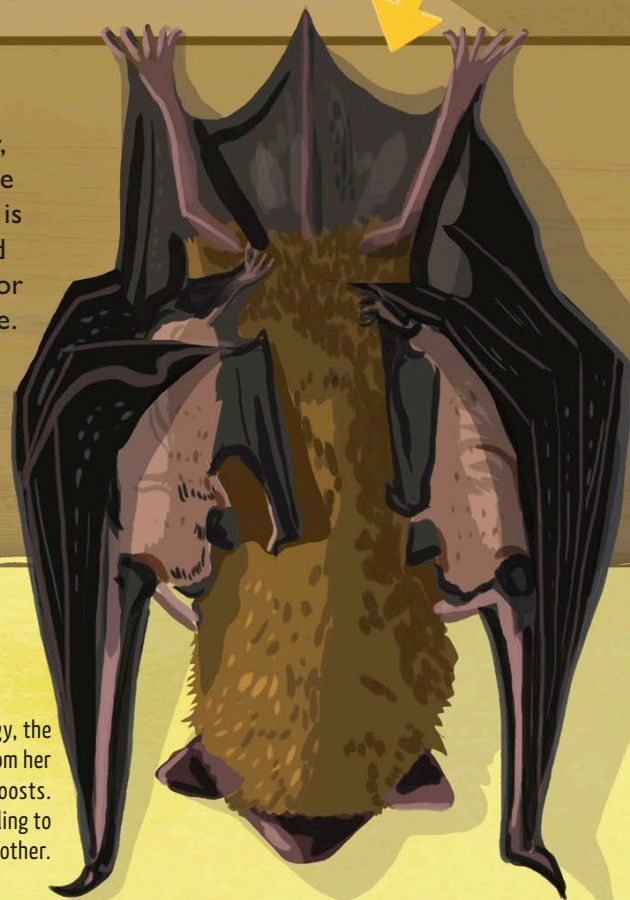
Maternity

Although they mate in the fall, females don't actually become pregnant until after hibernation, in the spring. The pregnant females gather in maternity roosts. Their pregnancies last about 60 days.

Bats are helpful to farmers—they eat insects that can harm crops and animals.

Bat-sitting

From late April to early July, female bats give birth to one or two pups. Each baby bat is small enough to curl around your finger and is helpless for the first few weeks of its life. The females do all of the parenting, and they even babysit pups from other families.



Clever moth There is a particular species of moth that can interfere with the echolocation of bats. By disrupting the sound system, it saves itself from getting eaten!

To save energy, the mother hangs from her feet when she roosts. The baby bats cling to their mother.

